



KAMAL NATH

Road Transport and Highways Minister



ANAND SHARMA

Commerce and Industry Minister



DAYANIDHI MARAN

Textiles Minister

Kamal Nath is making presentations to investors from Zurich to Singapore to attract investments into \$60 bn worth of new highway projects.

The Ministry has created a special non-profit vehicle called Invest India to project the country as a destination and is promising faster clearances by the FIPB.

Maran is holding roadshows in the US, Japan and Europe to attract strategic investment in technical textiles and export-oriented garment units.

whether to go through an automatic route or set up a joint venture.

The commerce ministry has also liberalised FDI norms by now including, under FDI, investments by Non Resident Indians, Foreign Institutional Investors, American Depository Receipts, Global Depository Receipts and convertible preference shares.

The Ministry of Heavy Industries is setting up seven Auto Testing Centres to make India an auto hub in which cars would be tested before they roll out on roads. According to Ambuj Sharma, joint secretary of the ministry, in these centres, car manufacturers of Indonesia, Malaysia and Thailand would be allowed to test their products. "This is part of the Government's attempt to invite more

foreign direct investment in the automobile sector," he says.

With energy security high on priority, the Ministry of Petroleum has pushed through 100 per cent FDI in LNG terminals. The incentives given for petroleum pipelines have been extended to natural gas as well to create a National Gas Grid, which was a long-standing demand of industry. The extension of income tax holiday for companies involved in oil and gas production will help in increased investments in indigenous production.

The roadshows for the New Exploration Licensing Policy (NELP) VIII in Houston and Calgary saw over 50 participants including Exxon Mobil and Conoco Philips, BP Plc, BG Group, and TOTAL. NELP VIII is expected to

fetch FDI worth \$5 billion. "We are looking forward to active participation from Indian and international investors," says Petroleum Minister Murli Deora.

Power Minister Sushil Kumar Shinde has taken to courting global investors in New York to explore India's power sector. The power ministry has made bidding documents standardised and competitive bidding route as the norm. According to Shinde, the scope for investment in the power sector alone over the next few years is well over \$300 billion. "The expansion programme in this sector would definitely need a large amount of FDI," says Shinde. The ministry has also drawn up a strategy for inviting investment in clean energy with pro-